

Is It A Dream or What?



Dreamlinux 3.5: Debian's goodness, with a revamped user interface and out-of-the-box multimedia support.

The look and feel factor leaves a mark on everyone—as the Mac OS X has proved over the years. We have had a distro from GNU/Linux userland that is reminiscent of the OS X desktop. So, when Dreamlinux 3.5 came out this March, I decided to take it for a ride. Here I present the results of the test drive.

To begin with, here are the specs of my test system:

- AMD Phenom X3 8650 over-clocked to 3.013 GHz
- AMD 790GX motherboard with ATI HD3300 graphics
- 4GB DDR2 800 MHz RAM
- Western Digital 640GB Aaks hard disk
- HP all-in-one 1410

The onset of a beautiful dream

Dreamlinux comes in two flavours, featuring the minimal XFCE and the feature-rich GNOME. I chose the XFCE edition. This is packed into a 695 MB ISO image (which is bundled in this month's LFY DVD), while the ISO image for the GNOME edition comes packed in an awkward 913 MB size, which will push you to burn a

DVD, leaving you with a lot of wasted storage space. I really wished for a bigger ISO image if they wanted to force users to burn a DVD. Anyway, I downloaded and burned both.

Restarting the PC with the XFCE CD inside, I was confronted with a bluish boot splash screen. Now if you have used an older version of Dreamlinux, you won't be pleased, as there is no change in the boot loader screen. There are only two entries here—one to boot the XFCE desktop and the other for memory diagnostics.

I booted the disc and to my surprise it was all verbose mode. Thankfully, it didn't take too long to load the desktop—back to a GUI, thankfully!



Tips: The live CD should load the desktop without any human

intervention. However, if you do run into trouble, and the system asks for a user name and password 'which is quite irrelevant for a live CD', don't panic—'dreamer' is the user name and 'dream' is the password. If you run into X server problems (for example, if the GUI fails to load), try reconfiguring your X by using the following command: `sudo dpkg-`